APPENDIX III: COMMENTS FROM THE U.S. AGENCY FOR INTERNATIONAL DEVELOPMENT

OFFICE OF THE DIRECTOR OF NATIONAL INTELLIGENCE
WASHINGTON, DC 20511

April 8, 2008

Ms. Janet St. Laurent
Managing Director, Defense Capabilities
and Management
United States Government Accountability Office
Washington, D.C. 20548

Dear Ms. St. Laurent:

(U) The Office of the Director of National Intelligence and the National Counterterrorism Center appreciate the opportunity to review the GAO report number 08-622 *Combating Terrorism: U.S. Lacks Comprehensive Plan to Destroy Terrorist Threat and Close Safe Haven in Pakistan's Federally Administered Tribal Areas*. Although we agree that the United States has not yet met its national security goals in Pakistan's Federally Administered Tribal Areas (FATA), we disagree that the United States lacks plans to combat terrorism in the area.

(U) Effectively countering the growth of extremism and the emergence of terrorist safehavens requires all elements of national power, to include diplomatic, military, development assistance, financial, law enforcement, and intelligence. The National Security Council, the Department of State, and the Department of Defense, have, therefore, been actively involved in the United States Government efforts to deny our terrorist enemies safehavens such as the FATA. The Office of the Director of National Intelligence, the National Counterterrorism Center, and the Intelligence Community have also been actively involved in such efforts.

(U) The National Counterterrorism Center, for example, produced the landmark National Implementation Plan for the War on Terror, which was signed by the President in June 2006, and was the first-ever United States Government-wide strategic plan for countering terrorism. This war plan does not stand alone. Rather, it complements two types of planning efforts that have long existed and continue to exist: (1) high-level national strategies directed by the President and the National Security and Homeland Security Councils, and (2) very granular and tactical department and agency-specific implementation plans.

(U) The National Counterterrorism Center (NCTC) has also been expanding its ongoing efforts to coordinate near-term department and agency activities at the strategic operational level in certain key regions of the world. NCTC combines regional and functional priorities to ensure its strategic operational planning initiatives, which by definition are interagency in nature, properly balance high-level and mission centric perspectives, and are comprehensive in drawing on all instruments of national power. NCTC has participated in a recently-completed interagency initiative to determine counterterrorism priorities, which, along with other efforts, provide a regional perspective to functional efforts and plans, such as the National Implementation Plan.

development strategy in tandem with the GOP and organizing a FATA donor's discussion at the fall 2006 World Bank/IMF meetings in Singapore.

- USAID initially started with small scale programs in education, health and microfinance as pilots which then determined the strategy for our larger programs currently being implemented.

In conclusion, we feel that the GAO should recognize the Government of Pakistan, USAID and the wider country team for advancing strategic thinking on the FATA development program.

Thanks very much for the opportunity to comment on this report and for the courtesies extended by your staff in the conduct of this review.

Sincerely,

Lisa Chiles

Lisa Chiles
Deputy Assistant Administrator
Bureau for Asia

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Combating Islamic Militancy and Terrorism in Pakistan's Border Region, Nova Science Publishers, Incorporated, 2010. ProQuest Ebook Central,